straw: on my complaining of this to the commissary, he said, he would send to St. Omer's for coverlets. After informing him further, that I had found captains, passengers, and mates confined in France, but that I supposed persons of this description in England were on their parole of honour; he replied, and desired I would note it down, that "a parole could not be granted without security; a hundred guineas for captains, seventy-five for mates, sixty for sailors, and twenty-five for boys." Passengers were on the same footing with captains. On the second day of my being there, the rules (the same as at Dunkirk) were hung up, both within and without this prison.

Many of the prisoners in this and other prisons had no change of linen, and some were almost entirely destitute of clothes, being the crews of vessels shipwrecked in the great storm of 31 December, 1778.

There were twenty-six of our people in a spacious ward in the military hospital, to whom great attention was paid. Each had a bed and sheets; and their bread and meat were good. But most of them having a disorder which did not break their spirits, they would have been better pleased if their allowance had been equal to that in the prison.

"TOULON. The galleys, formerly at Marseilles, are now removed to the arsenal at Toulon. Five were moored near each other, and have their names on the stern, as the *Firm*, the *Brave*, the *Intrepid*, etc. In them there were about sixteen hundred prisoners, who are obliged always to wear a bonnet or cap, on which is fixed a tin plate with a number. Their caps were grey, green, and red, to distinguish deserters, smugglers, and thieves; these last are always branded before they leave the prison of the place where they were condemned; some with the letter V (for *voleur*) others with G A L on the left shoulder.

"These galleys had only one deck. Many of their windows in the roofs were open; and, being swept twice every day, they were clean, and not offensive. The slaves also were kept clean, and their clothing was neat, even in that galley which is appropriated to the aged and infirm. Some of them had been confined forty, fifty, and even sixty years. All have a coat, waistcoat, trousers, two shirts, and a pair of shoes, given them every year; and a great-coat every two years. They had good brown bread, well baked, in loaves weighing a pound and three-quarters. All had some little allowance in money, and to those who worked was granted an additional allowance of three sous every day for wine. In each galley there were two

cantons (little rooms) one for wine, for those who worked for government, the other for the sale of white bread, greens, etc.

"Many worked at their own trades, as shoemakers, basket-makers, etc., but none were allowed to keep shops on shore as formerly at Marseilles; nor have they the same convenience they had then for the sale of their work. Forty were at work in La Place (the square) in the city, digging and removing the soil for the foundation of a house for the intendant.[1] These were chained two and two, and when one wheeled the mould, the other carried the chain; but in digging, sawing, and other stationary employments, both worked. Many were at work in the arsenal; and employed, some in moving, hewing and sawing timber; and others in the cotton and thread manufactory. The number of those engaged in the last of these employments was about two hundred. They were lodged in an adjoining hall; and I observed, that when they left off work they were searched to prevent their secreting any of the materials. All were loaded with chains of some kind or other. Those employed in the manufactory (and some others in the arsenal) had only a ring on one leg; but this, and likewise the choice of irons, I found to be a distinction which might be purchased. The slaves who worked out of the arsenal were loaded with heavy chains; and few are able to escape: if any do escape, they are punished, when retaken, in various ways. Some by a confinement under heavier irons—some by a recommencement of the term of their confinement—some by whipping—and such as had been condemned for life, by hanging.

"Protestants are not compelled to attend at mass. The last person who was confined for his religion, was released about eight years ago. There is but one slave here who now professes himself a Protestant, and his name is François Condé. He has been confined in the galleys forty-two years, for being concerned with some boys in a quarrel, with a gentleman (who lost his gold-headed cane) in a private house in Paris. The boys were apprehended, and this Condé, though only fourteen years of age, and lame of one arm, was condemned to the galleys for life. After four or five years he procured a Bible, and learned by himself to read; and becoming, through close attention to the Scriptures, convinced that his religion was anti-christian, he publicly renounced it; and declared and defended his sentiments. Ever since he has continued a steady Protestant, humble and modest, with a character irreproachable and exemplary,

[1] This house will spoil the beauty of the square.